

Problem–Solution Fit Canvas 2.0

Automated Network Request Management — ServiceNow

Project

Automated Network Request Management

Date

02 October 2026

Purpose: validate that the proposed ServiceNow workflow directly addresses the operational needs identified across requesters, approvers, network fulfilment teams, and IT administrators.

1. CUSTOMER SEGMENT(S)

- Primary: End users / requesters who submit network-related service requests through the ServiceNow Service Portal.
- Secondary: Network fulfilment teams responsible for reviewing request information and carrying out approved network-related work.
- Supporting users: Approvers such as managers or security/compliance stakeholders who review requests before fulfilment.
- Platform stakeholder: IT administrators responsible for ServiceNow configuration, roles, ACLs, workflow maintenance, and operational troubleshooting.

2. JOBS-TO-BE-DONE / PROBLEMS

- Submit a network request through a clear, structured service catalog experience.
- Provide complete and relevant request information without unnecessary manual back-and-forth.
- Route the request through the required approval process before operational action.
- Give fulfilment teams a consistent request record containing the information needed for execution.
- Receive clear notifications about request creation and the workflow outcome.
- Maintain a traceable record of request data, approval decisions, updates, and workflow execution.
- For IT operations: reduce repetitive manual coordination, inconsistent processing, and avoidable data-entry errors.

3. TRIGGERS

- An employee or team needs a network-related service or change.
- A requester wants to submit a request without relying on informal communication or repeated manual coordination.
- An approval is required before the request can proceed to fulfilment.
- Network operations needs a standardized record containing the request details and current status.
- IT administrators need centralized visibility into workflow execution and request processing.

4. BEHAVIOUR: BEFORE / DURING / AFTER

- Before: the requester identifies a network need and looks for a structured way to submit it.
- During: the requester selects the catalog item, enters required variables, submits the request, and expects the workflow to handle routing and notifications.
- Approval stage: the designated approver reviews the request and records an approval decision.
- Fulfilment stage: the network fulfilment team uses the operational record and workflow outcome to continue the work.
- After: the requester receives the workflow outcome, while the organization retains the request and execution history for tracking and troubleshooting.

5. AVAILABLE SOLUTIONS / CURRENT APPROACHES

- Manual request handling: familiar but can depend heavily on human coordination and repeated follow-up.

- Unstructured communication: email, chat, or informal requests can make required information and approval status difficult to standardize.
- Standalone operational records: useful for storing information but may not provide a connected submission-to-approval journey.
- ServiceNow-based request management: provides a common platform for catalog intake, workflow automation, approval handling, record updates, notifications, and auditability.

6. CUSTOMER CONSTRAINTS

- The request form must remain simple enough for users who are not network specialists.
- Required request information must be captured consistently so fulfilment teams do not need repeated clarification.
- Approval routing must follow the organization's configured policy and remain traceable.
- Workflow behaviour must be reliable within the ServiceNow platform and its configured roles, ACLs, catalog variables, and Flow Designer logic.
- The current implementation is focused on the demonstrated ServiceNow request lifecycle; direct network-device/API automation, advanced analytics, external messaging channels, and AI-driven classification are treated as future scope.

7. CUSTOMER NEEDS / EXPECTED OUTCOMES

- Requester: simple submission, clear status visibility, and timely workflow notifications.
- Approver: structured approval request with enough information to make a decision and an auditable decision trail.
- Network fulfilment team: complete and standardized request information with less repetitive coordination.
- IT administrator: maintainable Flow Designer automation, controlled access, and useful execution details for troubleshooting.
- Organization: a centralized and traceable request lifecycle that reduces manual effort and improves process consistency.

8. CHANNELS OF BEHAVIOUR

- Online: ServiceNow Service Portal / Service Catalog, catalog item form, request records, approval interaction, and email notifications.
- Operational: ServiceNow request and operational records used by IT and network fulfilment teams.
- Administrative: Flow Designer and Execution Details used by IT administrators for configuration, monitoring, and troubleshooting.
- Offline / physical: the actual network fulfilment activity performed by the responsible operations team is outside the automated ServiceNow workflow boundary.

9. PROBLEM ROOT CAUSE

- Network requests can require several people and process steps, making manual coordination difficult to manage consistently.
- Required information may be captured differently when requests are handled without a standardized catalog structure.
- Approval, fulfilment, notification, and status updates can become disconnected when they depend on separate manual actions.
- Repeated manual data entry creates opportunities for incomplete or inconsistent records.
- Limited workflow visibility can make it harder for requesters and administrators to understand the current state of a request.
- Troubleshooting is more difficult when workflow execution and record changes are not centrally traceable.

10. YOUR SOLUTION

- A ServiceNow-based Automated Network Request Management solution using Service Catalog for structured request intake.
- Catalog variables and form behaviour to capture the information required by the workflow and fulfilment process.
- Flow Designer to automate the request lifecycle from submission through record creation, approval, branching, updates, and notifications.
- A configured operational record to store the request information and workflow outcome in a structured form.
- Approval handling that evaluates the configured approval result and routes the request into approved or rejected outcomes.
- Email notifications to communicate request creation and workflow resolution.
- Role/ACL-based access and ServiceNow execution details to support controlled access, traceability, and troubleshooting.
- Future scope: broader network-service categories, deeper fulfilment integrations, automated network-device/API actions, advanced dashboards/analytics, external messaging, and AI-assisted classification or prioritization.

PROBLEM–SOLUTION FIT SUMMARY

Problem fit	The solution directly targets fragmented request handling, incomplete information, manual approval coordination, weak status visibility, and repetitive operational effort.
Workflow fit	The proposed journey connects catalog submission, variable retrieval, operational record creation, approval, decision branching, updates, and notifications within ServiceNow.
Stakeholder fit	The design addresses the needs of requesters, approvers, network fulfilment teams, and IT administrators without assuming that all operational work is fully automated.
Scope fit	The current solution remains focused on the ServiceNow workflow demonstrated for the project; deeper external integrations and advanced intelligence are future enhancements.

Reference basis: structure and canvas dimensions were adapted from the uploaded Problem–Solution Fit Canvas 2.0. Content has been rewritten for Automated Network Request Management rather than copied from the reference.

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